



YOU AFFECT THE WORLD BY WHAT YOU BROWSE

THE LAUNCH OF THE FIRST WEBSITE (1991)

IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Communication and computing

BEFORE

1943–1944 John Mauchly and J. Presper Eckert build the Electronic Numerical Integrator and Calculator (ENIAC), the forebear of digital computers.

1947 The transistor allows for small, powerful electronics, enabling later developments such as home computers.

1962 The Telstar 1 satellite is launched, sending TV signals, telephone calls, and fax images through space.

1980s The first mobile phones come onto the market.

AFTER

2000s The boom in wireless communication connects nearly all of humankind.

2003 The invention of Skype allows for free communication over the Internet.

The first website was titled “World Wide Web” and gave basic information about the World Wide Web project and how to create Web pages. It was built by Tim Berners-Lee, a British computer scientist at the European Organization for Nuclear Research (CERN) in Geneva, Switzerland.

The US military sets up the **Advanced Research Projects Agency Network (ARPANET)**.

The **ARPANET** grows and develops to become **the Internet**.

The first website is launched to help users navigate the Internet.

The Web becomes a **global telecommunications tool** used by millions.

The Internet radically changes how the world **shares information and conducts business**.

Berners-Lee was interested in facilitating the exchange of ideas between scientists in universities and research institutes, and he first proposed his idea for a worldwide network of computers sharing information in 1989. His site went live in 1991 and was accessed by a small group of fellow CERN researchers. Crucially, Berners-Lee persuaded CERN that the World Wide Web should be given to the world as a free resource.